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Graduate Recruitment Team

Oxford Economics

4 Millbank

London SW1P 3JA

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 UK Graduate Programme in Belfast or London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Oxford Economics' Global Economic Model, which links 80 countries and is relied on by more than 200 organisations, is the most ambitious version of the empirical modelling I have come to enjoy.

The work I am proudest of follows a consulting arc: diagnose with data, recommend a change, then make it happen. At KONG, I analysed sales patterns and used them to refine our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge in Glasgow, I created the house cocktails and set the specifications for its classics from launch, wrote the batch specifications the team works to, and trained around 15 bar staff, several new to cocktail bartending, to deliver them consistently.

Consulting appeals to me for the range of problems and the standard of thinking it demands: a recommendation has to be structured, evidenced and clear enough for a client to act on. My dissertation applies the same discipline to a broad question, whether news improves forecasts of European gas volatility, by breaking it into testable parts using mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models and out-of-sample comparisons against benchmarks. In co-founding the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I built an organisation from launch to 126 members and led weekly sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC.

Oxford Economics stands out to me because its forecasts rest on a globally integrated model and are willing to differ from the consensus; in April 2026 its global macro team put world growth at 2.9% against the IMF's 3.1% and expected Brent crude to average \$90 a barrel, around \$10 above the IMF's implied assumption. Energy prices are central to my dissertation, and two years of six-month rotations, with the option of a Belfast base where I grew up, make this an unusually strong fit.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan